

OBJECTIVE CONDITIONS

Researcher's Race, Class, Gender, Age, Ethnicity, and Nationality

Is the purpose of the research to address practical issues, concerns, & problems through action?

YES

Select another research design

Define the problem that needs to be addressed

Review past actions taken to solve same/similar issue

Review past studies/efforts

Research Prob/ Issue

Clearly define the problem and the context in which it was born: what factors (social, economic, political, environmental) gave rise to the issue? What fueled its growth & development?

Identify the problem's solution (opposite of a problem is its solution)

Framework/ Model

Action Strategy

Review of approaches others have used to study and address problem—past efforts, successes, mistakes, lessons

Review what has been written about past efforts

Observe the results/ outcomes of past efforts

Talk with people involved in past efforts

Acquire/Construct appropriate data collection & recording instruments

Questionnaire, observation checklist, organized field journal, notebook

Train research team, if necessary, according to the appropriate data collection design

Construct a plan of action to address problem: consider the issue, population members & their interests/needs, potential challenges, the process for assessing progress & outcomes, information & resource needs, available human & material resources, and timeframe

Define goals, objectives, inputs, outcomes, benchmarks, & other relevant measures

Establish research action team & allocate responsibilities

Is a cost-benefit analysis necessary?

yes

Evaluate potential tangible & intangible consequences of action/solution

Assign value—contingency & actual

no

Evaluate likelihood of various consequences

Identify positive & negative consequences

Revise action/solution based upon outcome of analysis

Define the process & techniques for assessing effectiveness of action plan with appropriate timeframes – evaluate completion of goals, outcomes, etc.

How will completion of goals be measured and evaluated?

What data/information will be used to determine if a goal/objective/outcome has been met?

Implement the action plan

Carefully monitor the implementation of the proposed action/solution

Gather data on plan's effectiveness in addressing problem according to the chosen data collection technique

Organize, and process data (enter into computer, clean of error & bias, etc.)

Analyze quantitative & qualitative components of data

Critically analyze race, class, gender, culture, & generation biases of data source

Reveal embedded assumptions—socio-economic, political, theoretical, methodological, logical, conceptual

Analysis moves from general to specific, then back to general

Assess the boundaries & influential forces in system

Construct a mental reflection of objective reality

Evaluate effectiveness of overall research & recommended changes

Has the problem been addressed/resolved?

no

yes

Assess why & determine if must revisit an earlier stage in process

Assess lessons learned: what worked, what didn't, & under what circumstances

Develop policy/standards/guiding principles according to lessons learned